

MOVIE

Uncharted

★★★★☆ | The Uncharted movie suffers from the same fate as most video game movie adaptations suffer from. It's not very good. Sonic the Hedgehog is still in our opinion the best video game movie adaptation we've seen so far, and even that's not a great movie. It's good, not great. Video games have the potential to be great movies, and the Uncharted franchise in itself is almost like watching an action movie where you play as the main character. So the fact that it was going to be adapted into a movie was not all that surprising to us.

We had our doubts when we first heard that Tom Holland would be playing Nathan Drake, however, but we decided to hold judgement when we found out that the movie would



be a prequel to the games, so a younger Drake. Plus, Holland seemed like a good fit, considering the fact that he was already used to swinging off and around tall structures.

Fortunately, Holland does a fine job as Nathan Drake, and his charm

was enough to carry the movie, at least in our opinion.

The movie itself lacks substance. It's full of high octane action sets at exotic and beautiful locations, much like the games it's based on, but that's about it. The story is meh at best. Despite that, thanks to the casting, the movie still ends up being a largely enjoyable affair.

Tom Holland's Nathan Drake and Mark Wahlberg's Sully make a good on-screen duo and could probably carry another movie, if they actually worked on a more substantial plot. Sophia Ali playing Chloe Frazier does a decent job as well.

The Uncharted movie is one you can enjoy by turning your brain off and simply enjoying the action and the occasional witty one-liners thrown at you. Trying to think too much about what's happening and why it's happening simply diminishes the amount of enjoyment you can derive from the film.

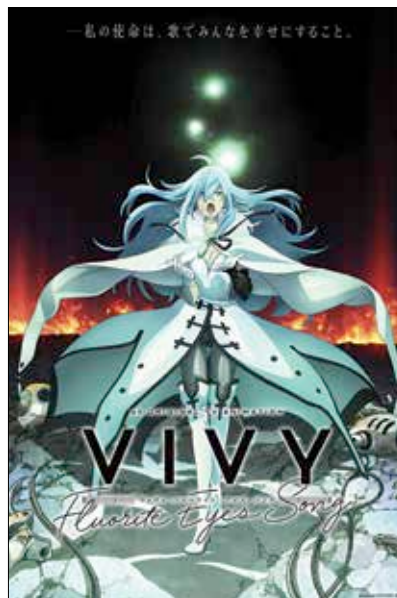
—Manish Rajesh

ANIME

Vivy: Fluorite Eye's Song

★★★★☆ | Throughout the 13-episode duration of VIVY: Fluorite Eye's Song, this question recurs. Neither the premise nor the location are very unique: we've all been exposed to future settings, the notion of A.I., and the impending human-A.I. war plotline, whether through movies or vintage anime shows. Nonetheless, I would argue that what this specific series does with this premise is noteworthy.

Every episode makes the most of its running time, and there are so many great sequences. The action never stops, and there's always a new twist or development to keep you interested. There are amazing battle sequences and action, melancholy emotional moments, some light



humorous aspects, and just moments that will leave you stunned and engrossed in the present. The world-building is probably a little sparse, but that's really one of the story's main shortcomings. There are many interesting ideas in this book, including

transhumanism and what it means to be human. It's rather standard fare for anyone who's seen similar programming, but it's executed admirably.

The art and animation are two of the show's strengths. Vivy features some of the year's greatest animated hand-to-hand combat sequences. They did a good job with the CG as well, albeit some CG models may stand out like a sore thumb. The creators did an excellent job blending 2D and 3D animation.

The gloomy nature of its themes, along with the knowledge that one incorrect move or things not going as planned might result in failure and the death of mankind, as well as the drama that goes along with it, makes this an exciting anime that bears comparisons to Steins;Gate and Re:Zero. Despite the fact that this programme is about an idol rescuing the world and will not appeal to the majority of viewers owing to its idol-related nature, it is one to watch.

—Omang Baheti